

AirSense: SAMEER Complaint Workflow and the Real Operational Gap

An evidence-based assessment of what happens today, what remains difficult for nodal officers, and where AirSense can help without replacing SAMEER.

Bottom line

The problem is real, but the framing must be precise. SAMEER already provides intake, geolocation-based assignment, tracking, and a stated 24-hour redressal expectation. AirSense should not claim to solve complaint registration or replace the government workflow. Its credible contribution is an operational layer that helps officers handle many related complaints as one incident, decide what deserves attention first, prepare a reviewable action plan, and measure closure.

This is a genuine workflow-efficiency problem, not proof that every complaint is ignored. Official records show both strong resolution performance for some agencies and substantial unresolved backlogs for others. That mixed picture is exactly why the product should target triage quality and workload visibility rather than make an unsupported claim of universal failure.

1. What the current workflow appears to be

Stage	Current process	Evidence/qualification
1. Citizen submission	Citizen logs a complaint through SAMEER, CPCB website, email, or social channels. In the app, the user provides location/GPS, category, description, and photographs and receives a complaint ID.	CPCB guidance describes these intake channels and the app tracking flow.
2. Central intake and monitoring	The CPCB Central Control Room monitors complaints. Website and email complaints may be transferred manually into SAMEER for centralized monitoring. Social-media complaints are handled through a media-management process.	The guideline explicitly describes a CCR and manual transfer from website/email.
3. Routing to an agency	The system assigns complaints based on location and pollution type to an appropriate nodal agency: municipal body, development authority, police/traffic, transport, industrial department, public works, and others.	Automatic geographic assignment is stated in CPCB guidance.
4. Departmental handling	A nodal officer reviews the assigned complaint, may forward it to the responsible official or department, coordinates field action/inspection, and gathers evidence.	A DPCC report provides this kind of agency-specific handoff example.
5. Resolution evidence	The agency records action taken and uploads comments, photographs, or other documentary/visual proof.	CPCB guidance states that action and visual/documentary proof are expected.
6. Tracking and escalation	The citizen checks the complaint ID and action history. Delays are monitored centrally and notified to agencies; unresolved matters require follow-up or escalation.	The workflow includes online tracking and central monitoring, but public material does not establish that every complaint is solved within 24 hours.

2. Is the issue real? What the evidence supports

Yes—but it is narrower than “government has no complaint system.” The official workflow already handles intake and basic routing. The stronger problem statement is: **once many complaints enter the system, officers and agencies still need to convert a stream of individual reports into a manageable, evidence-backed operational workload.**

- Duplicate reports can represent one physical event, but the official material reviewed does not describe a deduplication layer.

- Routing answers which agency should receive a complaint; it does not necessarily answer which incident should be handled first across all open incidents.
- An officer may still need to inspect descriptions, compare locations and timestamps, recognize repeated reports, coordinate internally, and prepare a response.
- The 24-hour expectation creates a deadline, but not necessarily a decision-support mechanism for severity, exposure, complaint concentration, or trend.
- Closure evidence is recorded, yet a structured before/after learning loop is not apparent in the public workflow description.

CPCB's status table for 15 October 2021–2 September 2025 reports 13,232 SAMEER complaints: 9,098 resolved (69%) and 4,134 not resolved (31%). Variation is substantial: Delhi's Municipal Corporation shows 2,921 resolved out of 5,852 (50%), while Delhi Jal Board shows 151 of 266 (57%); other agencies show much higher percentages. This does not prove AirSense would cause resolution, but it does show a material operational workload and uneven closure performance.

3. Where AirSense fits—and where it must not

Current step	AirSense role	Honest claim
Citizen files complaint	No replacement in the prototype. Keep SAMEER/CPCB as the intake channel.	Works behind the existing channel.
Location/category routing	Consume routed records or synthetic equivalents; preserve agency ownership and provenance.	Improves downstream handling, not jurisdiction.
Officer reviews queue	Cluster nearby, same-category, time-related complaints into probable incidents; show linked complaints and uncertainty.	Reduces repeated reading without silently deleting records.
Officer decides action order	Rank clusters with volume, severity, age, local AQI and trend; allow manual override.	Decision support, not automatic enforcement.
Officer coordinates action	Generate a structured draft recommendation with evidence, responsible agency, suggested next step, and missing information.	Drafting aid; officer remains accountable.
Agency closes complaint	Capture action, evidence, status, and before/after AQI snapshot where appropriate.	Creates an impact log; does not independently verify field action.

4. What your team should change before building

- Do not say “SAMEER uses FIFO” unless you have direct evidence. Say that public documentation does not describe cross-complaint deduplication or transparent priority scoring.
- Do not say “40 reports become one ticket.” Say “40 reports become one probable incident cluster while all original records remain traceable.”
- Do not let an LLM decide enforcement. Generate a draft containing evidence, rationale, suggested agency/action, confidence, and escalation conditions.
- Treat AQI as contextual evidence, not proof that a complaint caused AQI. Timestamp readings and show data freshness.
- Measure complaints reviewed per incident, duplicate reduction, time to identify top incidents, officer ranking agreement, recommendation edit rate, and closure-record completeness.
- Pilot with one agency and one category first, such as construction dust or open burning.

5. Recommended final problem statement

“SAMEER already collects and routes air-pollution complaints. The operational gap is downstream: repeated reports, multiple agencies, uneven urgency, and fragmented evidence make it harder for nodal officers to see the incident behind the ticket stream and act consistently within the response window. AirSense is a transparent

decision-support layer that clusters related complaints, ranks probable incidents, drafts reviewable next actions, and records outcomes—without replacing SAMEER or removing officer accountability.”

Verdict

You are not wasting your time if you build AirSense as an officer-operations layer and validate it honestly. You would be wasting time if you build another citizen complaint form, claim that SAMEER has no routing or monitoring, or present an AI-generated recommendation as a substitute for inspection and government judgment.

Sources and evidence notes

1. CPCB, “Guidelines for Management of Complaints Related to Air pollution in NCR”: complaint channels, SAMEER submission/tracking, Central Control Room, agency assignment, 24-hour expectation, evidence upload, and manual transfer of website/email complaints. [web:2]
2. CPCB, “Redressal Status of Air Pollution Related Complaints Received on Sameer App,” 15 October 2021–2 September 2025: agency-level received/resolved/not-resolved figures and grand total 13,232 / 9,098 / 4,134. [web:18]
3. DPCC Annual Report 2021–22 search result: example of nodal-officer receipt, internal forwarding, and closure with resolved photo/comment; used cautiously as an agency-specific example. [web:3]
4. User-provided AirSense 14-Day Execution Plan: proposed clustering, priority scoring, recommendations, and outcome tracking. [file:1]